TRT 04

Human chorionic gonadotropin (hCG)

Placental glycoprotein hormone with alpha and beta subunits, purified from the urine of pregnant women



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Hormone (glycoprotein)	Testes, hypogonadism	Large trials; FDA approved	FDA approved (Novarel, Pregnyl)

STUDIED FOR

- **Hypogonadism** — HUMAN
- **Undescended testis** — HUMAN
- **Testis T on TRT** — HUMAN
- **Weight loss** — HUMAN

Use with testosterone is off-label. Studies of hCG alongside TRT are small: a 3-week trial in 29 men and a chart review of 26 men.

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- Novarel approved 1974, Pregnyl 1976
- With TRT: 29-man RCT, 26-man chart review
- No large trials with TRT found

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term use with TRT
- Fertility outcomes on TRT
- Half-life in men

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

hCG ▶ LH receptor ▶ Leydig cells ▶ Testosterone

- **Label:** action is almost the same as pituitary LH, with slight FSH activity
- **Label:** stimulates Leydig cells of the testis to make androgens
- **Label:** no known effect on fat, appetite or hunger

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established	Injection into muscle (label)
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Not established (labels give no data)	Prescription biologic (Novarel, Pregnyl)
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Testosterone inside the testis, semen (studies)	Prohibited in males, class S2

REGULATORY

- **FDA** — Approved; regulated as a biologic since 2020
- **FDA** — Not eligible for 503A/503B compounding
- **WADA** — Prohibited in males at all times (S2)

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Pregnyl prescribing information, Dec 2025
2. FDA, Notice to compounders on biologics, Mar 2020
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

Adonis Men's Health · checked Nov 2026. Research and regulator records only. Not medical advice.

adonismenshealth.com